

TOP FIVE FINDINGS

U.S. Health Insurance Costs, 2000–2023

1. Health insurance costs dropped noticeably after the 2020 peak, likely due to Congressional COVID-era subsidies. This effect is visible in all graphs, Figures 1–4.
2. Health insurance costs increased for all income levels from 2000 to 2023.
3. Lower-income households spend a much higher percentage of their total expenses on health insurance than higher-income households, and this percentage has increased substantially from 2000 to 2023.
4. Higher-income households saw the largest increases in real-dollar spending, now exceeding \$9,000 annually.
5. During ACA implementation (2010–2014), rising costs slowed and shifted into a different long-term pattern.